



Cost-of-Living Survey

This survey is being conducted by the International Civil Service Commission (ICSC) and is addressed to staff of United Nations Common System organizations in the **Professional and higher categories (P-1 to D-2) and Field Service category (FS-6 and FS-7)** at your duty station. The **purpose** of this survey is to elicit information on the expenditures of eligible staff of the UN common system organizations (including their household members). The information collected is used to **estimate an average expenditure pattern** of international staff and their households at your **duty station**. The resulting pattern is an essential element in the calculation of the Post Adjustment Index which is a major element of the net remuneration of eligible staff.

The user-friendly questionnaire can be completed in about 30 minutes in one or multiple sessions. You can save the partially completed questionnaire at any time and recover it later for completion within the survey month, by using your personal password that was sent to your email address upon registration. [In order to access the questionnaire for the first time, please register by completing the registration form. For additional information about the survey including survey-related documents and FAQs on all aspects of the survey, please visit our survey support micro-site at <https://surveys.unicsc.org/cold>.](#)

This survey is **strictly confidential** in accordance with the international statistical standards and the information you provide will not be associated with you as an individual person in any way.

Thank you very much for your participation.

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REGISTRATION

UN E-mail Address

test@un.org

Counry of Assignment

Argentina

Primary Duty Station

Buenos Aires

Other City

Residence if different from primary duty station

Organization

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INTRODUCTION

It is very important that all eligible staff at the duty station complete the questionnaire as the results of this survey will affect staff members' net remuneration at the duty station. Only you can provide the required information about your household. No data provided in the questionnaire will be communicated to unauthorized persons. Your data will be used only as part of a statistical sample used to determine the relativity of cost of living of your duty station with New York, the base of the Post Adjustment System. **A high staff participation rate** is required for the data collected to be usable and for the results derived to be statistically valid.

Before you begin to fill in the questionnaire, **please read the detailed instructions carefully.**

If you have any questions, you may refer to the [Frequently Asked Questions](#) on the survey micro-site. If you still do not find the answers you seek, you may contact the ICSC secretariat directly through our contact page

LAYOUT OF THE QUESTIONNAIRE

SECTION 1: Respondent and household information

SECTION 2: Housing

SECTION 3: Domestic and security services cost

SECTION 4: Household expenditures on goods and services purchased

Please take the necessary time to complete all sections of the questionnaire that apply to your household's expenditures. Remember that an **incomplete questionnaire is not likely to be usable, in which case your efforts will be wasted.** Reporting your best estimate for any significant expenditures is better than leaving a questionnaire box blank.

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SECTION 1

SECTION 1: RESPONDENT AND HOUSEHOLD INFORMATION

Household members refer both to persons living with you during the survey month and those temporarily away (less than 6 months) from the duty station. We also collect information about other family members or persons who do not regularly live with you but for whom you provide financial support.

Date you were assigned to your duty station

Date	Month	Year

Date you moved to your present dwelling

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Category, grade, and step

Steps PP1 and PP2 correspond to pay protection points for staff beyond the maximum salaries on the unified salary scale

Category	Grade	Step
P		

Do you receive one of the following allowances?

Dependent Spouse Allowance	
Single Parent Allowance	
None of These	

Household composition: persons living in your current, primary dwelling and sharing income or expenditures for at least six months of the year

Adults (Including Yourself)	Children

Are there other family members or persons not part of your household (**not regularly living at your current, primary dwelling**) for whom you provide at least some financial support?

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Type of occupancy of your residence **at your current, primary dwelling**

Sharing / Living in Hotel

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SECTION 2 - HOUSING

SECTION 1: RESPONDENT AND HOUSEHOLD INFORMATION

This section has two parts (2.1 and 2.2). Part 2.1 elicits information about your primary residence including expenditures on rent, utilities, facilities, and other housing costs. Part 2.2 is for secondary residence **outside** of the country of duty station. Please record the amount which you currently pay on an average monthly basis, unless otherwise stated.

Housing related expenditures for dependents or other family members regularly living away from your current primary dwelling but **within the country of duty station** should be reported under "other expenditures" in section 4.1 (question 25).

Housing related expenditures for dependents or other family members regularly living away from your current primary dwelling, **outside of the country of duty station** should be reported under "remittances" in section 4.1 (question 24).

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SECTION 2 - HOUSING

Renter

[HOME OWNERS Click Here](#)

Is your primary residence inside the country of duty station? For this questionnaire, primary residence is defined as where you ordinarily live while reporting to work at the duty station

Yes

Select appropriate type of dwelling or residence *

Choose an item.

By whom is accommodation provided? *

Choose an item.

Number of rooms by type *

Studio

Bedrooms

Living room

Dining room

Study/office

Total area of living space (if available), please indicate the appropriate unit of measure: square feet or square meters)

Area

Unit

Current Rental Expenditures

Monthly Rent *

Amount

Currency

Apportioned cost (OR) condominium charges (monthly)

Does your monthly rent include the fee for a garage/parking facility?

No

If No, please indicate any recurring monthly fees you pay for a garage or parking facility, whether located on or off your premises.

Garage/parking facility (monthly)

Amount

Currency

Utilities and other dwelling costs (if not included in rent)

Is Electricity included in your rent?

No

Electricity Cost

Is Water included in your rent?

Yes

Do you have gas service (piped or other types) in your dwelling?

Yes

Is it included in your rent?

No

Gas Cost

Do you rely on any solid, liquid or other energy sources for household energy needs?

Yes

Are their costs included in your rent?

No

Cost of Solid, liquid or other sources of heat energy including fuel for electricity generator, such as propane, combustible oil, etc. (excluding electricity and gas if costs reported above cover heating)

Garbage collection

Exclude costs for garbage bags which should be reported in question 6 of section 4.1

Additional housing taxes or fees during the past 12 months

Local and housing taxes (residency permit, etc.)

Amount	Currency

Other Costs (during past 36 months)

Non-refundable one-time charges (e.g., Key money, Broker fees, Application fees)

Amount	Currency

Minor repairs and repainting

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Security cost after any reimbursements (alarm system, bars, etc.; excluding guards)

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SECTION 2 - HOUSING

Home Owner

[RENTERS Click Here](#)

Is your primary residence inside the country of duty station? For this questionnaire, primary residence is defined as where you ordinarily live while reporting to work at the duty station

No

Select appropriate type of dwelling or residence *

Choose an item.

Number of rooms by type *

Studio

No

Bedrooms

Living room

Dining room

Study/office

Total area of living space (if available), please indicate the appropriate unit of measure: square feet or square meters)

Area

Unit

If someone were to rent your home today, how much do you think it would rent for monthly, unfurnished and without utilities? *

Amount

Currency

Apportioned cost (OR) condominium charges (monthly)

Do you incur additional expenses for parking/garage facility?

Yes

If Yes, please indicate any recurring monthly fees you pay for a garage or parking facility, whether located on or off your premises.

Garage/parking facility (monthly)

Amount

Currency

Utilities and other dwelling costs

	Frequency	Amount	Currency
Electricity Cost			
Water Costs			
Do you have gas service (piped or other types) in your dwelling?	Yes		
Gas			
Do you rely on any solid, liquid or other energy sources for household energy needs?	No		
Garbage collection			

Exclude costs for garbage bags which should be reported in question 6 of section 4.1

Additional housing taxes or fees during the past 12 months

Local and housing taxes (residency permit, etc.)

Amount	Currency

Other housing costs (during past 36 months)

Minor repairs and repainting

Amount	Currency

Security cost after any reimbursements (alarm system, bars, etc.;
excluding guards)

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SECONDARY RESIDENCE

2.2 HOUSING EXPENDITURES FOR SECONDARY RESIDENCE OUTSIDE THE COUNTRY OF DUTY STATION

Housing expenditures in this section include **expenditures on secondary residence outside the country of the duty station including non-consumption commitments such as** mortgages or payments for housing loans, etc. Please report the total of all expenditures for housing, including rent, maintenance, and repair of the dwelling, utilities and other housing costs. If you require additional space to list more expense items, please report them under "Other Expenditures" in **Question 25** of the household section of the questionnaire..

	Amount	Currency	Rent/Mortgage?
Housing Expense			Mortgage
1. Monthly expenditures for rent (OR) mortgage for secondary residence OUTSIDE the country of duty station			
2. Monthly expenditures for Apportioned cost (OR) condominium charges for secondary residence OUTSIDE the country of duty station			
3. Monthly expenditures for utilities for secondary residence OUTSIDE the country of duty station			
4. Other monthly housing related expenditures for secondary residence OUTSIDE the country of duty station (Non-refundable one-time charges (e.g., Key money, Broker fees, Application fees); maintenance and minor repairs)			

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SECTION 3: Domestic and security services (Monthly expenditure)

This section elicits information about your expenditure on domestic services. Please record the domestic service type under the appropriate section irrespective of whether the service is offered full time or part time. Please do not include services such as piano lessons, after-school tutorials, summer camps, etc. as these are not classifiable as domestic services. On the other hand, gardeners, drivers/chauffeurs are classifiable as domestic services. You should indicate the total monthly compensation and the total hours worked per month against the total number of workers for each type of domestic service.

If you do not incur expenditures for domestic and security services, please skip this part and proceed to the next section.

Additional expenditures, for example, related to social security, bonuses (including thirteen month), periodic home country transportation, etc., should be prorated on a monthly basis and included in the total monthly compensation

Domestic service type

Housekeeping services

Cooking services

Babysitting/Child-minding services

Any combined housekeeping services/or cooking services/or baby-sitting services

Guard/Security services

Homecare services for elderly and disabled (not providing medical care)

Other Services such as driver, gardener etc (Please specify)

Number of workers	Total hours per month	Total monthly compensation	Currency

Monthly UN reimbursement amount for guard/security services

Amount	Currency

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SECTION 4 - HOUSEHOLD EXPENDITURES

This section elicits information about your average monthly or yearly household expenditures other than for housing and domestic services. Expenditure items are grouped into three parts (monthly, annually or Quinquennial) Expenditures are further categorized as incurred either inside or outside the country of duty station. Please record the appropriate currency used for each expenditure reported.

General guidelines in completing this section

Currency: Please select the appropriate currency of payment for expenditures. When entering amounts **please enter only numbers and avoid separators such as commas or decimal points.**

In-area/Out-of-Area expenditures: Expenditures of household or family members incurred inside the country of the duty station are classified as in-area while those incurred outside the country of the duty station are classified as out-of-area. Expenditures of family members or other persons supported financially who live within the country of the duty station, but not in your current, primary dwelling, are to be reported as in-area. Expenditures incurred by family members or other persons, supported financially by you, who live outside the country of the duty station, should be reported as remittances, except for education and medical expenditures, which should be reported as out-of-area.

Also DO NOT INCLUDE expenditures incurred while on work missions as such expenditures are normally covered by the organizations.

Classification of Internet purchases as in-area or out-of-area: If you know that the purchases were made at website addresses registered or otherwise regulated by the laws of the country of your duty station, **these should be classified as in-area**. If the website address is known to be registered or regulated according to the laws of other countries, or this information is not known or cannot be ascertained, **the purchases should be classified as out-of-area**.

Remittances: Include all money transferred abroad, regardless of whether or not it is for consumption or non-consumption commitments. Typically, they will include money transfers for the support of dependents living outside the country of the duty station. Remittances may include money transferred abroad for saving or for staff own household's deferred consumption. However, transfers for the **upkeep of dwellings abroad** (usually, but not necessarily, the home country), including mortgages, should be reported under the out-of-area housing expenditures, section 2.2 of the housing section of the questionnaire.

Timing of payment: Record the amount paid on the date of purchase. Credit card purchases should be recorded in full as on the date of purchase.

Taxes: All purchases should be recorded including sales tax (or VAT) and any other surcharge, such as delivery or service charge.

Other Expenditures: Please complete the section on other expenditures only after completing the entire questionnaire and having seen the full structure.

Glossary: Use the searchable glossary to find the question number corresponding to the expenditure category typed into the search box.

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4.1 MONTHLY EXPENDITURES

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Expenditure Category	INSIDE (the country of the duty station)		OUTSIDE (the country of the duty station)	
	In-area expenditure in local currency		Out-of-area expenditure	
	Amount	Currency	Amount	Currency
FOOD AND NON-ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES				
1 Food (purchased in supermarkets, stores, markets; but not purchased in restaurants, canteens, cafeterias or similar establishments)				
2 Non-alcoholic beverages (soft drinks, coffee, mineral water, etc.; purchased in supermarkets, stores, markets; but not purchased in restaurants, canteens, cafeterias or similar establishments)				
ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES, TOBACCO AND NARCOTICS				
3 Alcoholic beverages (beer, wine, spirits and liquors)				
4 Tobacco (<i>cigarettes, cigars and other tobacco products</i>)				
CLOTHING AND FOOTWEAR				
5 Cleaning, repair, tailoring and hire of clothing				
FURNISHINGS, HOUSEHOLD EQUIPMENT AND ROUTINE HOUSEHOLD MAINTENANCE				
6 Non-durable household goods (Household cleaning and maintenance products; Other non-durable household goods)				
HEALTH (not covered by insurance, out-of-pocket)				
7 Medicines (Medicines, vaccines and other pharmaceutical preparations; Herbal medicines and homeopathic products, etc.)				
TRANSPORT				
8 Fuels and lubricants for personal transport equipment				
9 Public transport and taxi services (local and long distance transport by rail or by road - rapid transit and tram, local bus, taxi, train, coach, etc.)				
10 Postal and courier services				
11 Other transport of goods (removal and storage services; delivery of goods)				
INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION				
12 Information and communication services (telephone, TV subscription, audiovisual streaming services, Internet and online storage, rental of audiovisual content, etc.)				
RECREATION, SPORT AND CULTURE				
13 Pets and pets products				
14 Veterinary and other services for pets				
15 Cultural services (cinemas, theatres and concerts venues, museums, libraries and cultural sites, photographic services; other cultural services, etc.)				
16 Recreational and sporting services				
17 Newspapers, books and stationery				
RESTAURANTS AND ACCOMMODATION SERVICES				
18 Restaurants, cafes and similar eating facilities (providing full or limited or self-service)				
19 Canteens, cafeterias and refectories (at work/office premises, universities, schools and kindergartens, etc.)				
INSURANCE AND FINANCIAL SERVICES				

Expenditures during a **representative (or average) month of the year**. Please indicate the amount you spend on each item for an average month. If the expenditure for an item is not incurred on monthly basis, estimate a monthly amount based on the total spent per year.

20	Insurance connected with health (supplementary medical insurance: complementary to basic insurance provided by your organization)				
21	Insurance connected with transport (insurance for cars, motobikes, scooters, travel insurance, etc.)				
22	Insurance connected with dwelling (Housing insurance services for theft, accident, natural disasters, etc.)				
PERSONAL CARE, SOCIAL PROTECTION AND MISCELLANEOUS GOODS AND SERVICES					
23	Hair dressing salons and personal grooming establishments				
OTHER MONTHLY EXPENDITURES					
For the purposes of this questionnaire, remittances Include all money transferred abroad, regardless whether for consumption or non-consumption commitments. Typically, they will include money transfers for the support of dependents living outside the country of the duty station, however expenditures incurred on health and education for such dependents should be reported under their respective categories.					
For other expenditures, please provide a brief description to enable the ICSC to properly classify them at the data processing stage					
24	Remittances				
25	Other Monthly Expenditures (please specify)				
	Other Monthly Expenditures (please specify)				
	Other Monthly Expenditures (please specify)				
	Other Monthly Expenditures (please specify)				

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4.2 ANNUAL EXPENDITURES

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Expenditure Category	INSIDE (the country of the duty station)		OUTSIDE (the country of the duty station)	
	In-area expenditure in local currency		Out-of-area expenditure	
	Amount	Currency	Amount	Currency

Please record the expenditures on each category **in the last 12 months** such as expenditures incurred only once or twice per year. If the expenditure is incurred more frequently (for example, on clothing or recreation and culture items) an estimate for the overall annual expenditure should be reported.

CLOTHING AND FOOTWEAR

26	Garments (clothing for: men or boys, women or girls, infants under 2 years of age, school uniforms)				
27	Other articles of clothing and clothing accessories				
28	Shoes and other footwear (for men, women, infants and children)				

FURNISHINGS, HOUSEHOLD EQUIPMENT AND ROUTINE HOUSEHOLD MAINTENANCE

29	Furniture, furnishings and loose carpets				
30	Household textiles				
31	Small household appliances				
32	Glassware, tableware and household utensils				
33	Tools and equipment for house and garden				

HEALTH (not covered by insurance: out-of-pocket)

34	Medical products (Medical diagnostic products, Preventive and protective devices, and treatment devices for personal use)				
35	Assistive products (Assistive products for vision, hearing and communication, mobility and daily living)				
36	Outpatient care services (preventive care, dental care, other curative and rehabilitative care, long-term care)				
37	In-patient care services (Curative and rehabilitative care, long-term care)				

TRANSPORT

38	Parts and accessories for personal transport equipment				
39	Maintenance and repair of personal transport equipment				
40	Other services related to personal transport equipment				
41	Passenger transport by air				

INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION

42	Information and communication equipment (Mobile phone equipment; Information processing equipment; Equipment for the reception, recording and reproduction of sound and vision; Other information and communication equipment and accessories)				
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RECREATION, SPORT AND CULTURE

43	Sport, camping and open-air equipment				
44	Games, toys and hobby-related articles				
45	Garden products, plants and flowers				
46	Package holidays (all-inclusive holidays and tours; excursion tours; ...)				

RESTAURANTS AND ACCOMMODATION SERVICES

47	Accommodation services (Hotels, motels and camping, holiday centers and similar accommodation services, etc.)				
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INSURANCE AND FINANCIAL SERVICES

48	Financial services (explicit charges for the financial services of commercial banks, credit unions, cooperative banks, savings banks, ...)				
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PERSONAL CARE, SOCIAL PROTECTION AND MISCELLANEOUS GOODS AND SERVICES

49	Personal care				
49.a	Electric appliances for personal care				
49.b	Other appliances, articles and products for personal care				

50 Other personal effects

50.a. Social protection (Retirement homes and residences for disabled persons - not providing medical care, etc.)

50.b. Other personal effects (travel goods, baby articles and other personal effects, etc.)

50.c. Other services (religious services, legal services, estate agents services, funeral services, photocopies and other reproductions of documents, etc.)

OTHER ANNUAL EXPENDITURES

51 Other Annual Expenditures (please specify)

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EDUCATION SERVICES (ANNUAL)

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Expenditure Category	INSIDE (the country of the duty station)		OUTSIDE (the country of the duty station)	
	In-area expenditure in local currency		Out-of-area expenditure	
	Amount	Currency	Amount	Currency

EDUCATION SERVICES

52 Tuition and enrollment fees for education other than tertiary level (primary, secondary, post-secondary but non-tertiary)

52.a Tuition and enrolment fees excluding capital assessment/surcharges				
52.b Accommodation services of boarding schools, universities and other educational establishments				
52.c Canteens and cafeterias of universities, schools and kindergartens				
52.d Educational books and textbooks				
52.e Passenger transport for students to and from school				
52.f Childcare services				
52.g Recreational and leisure services / Other cultural services				
52.h Do you receive Education Grant?	Yes			
52.i Reimbursement for education costs - Total received				Add dependent / self

53 Tertiary Education

53.a Tuition and enrolment fees excluding capital assessment/surcharges				
53.b Accommodation services of boarding schools, universities and other educational establishments				
53.c Canteens and cafeterias of universities, schools and kindergartens				
53.d Educational books and textbooks				
53.e Passenger transport for students to and from school				
53.f Childcare services				
53.g Recreational and leisure services / Other cultural services				
53.h Do you receive Education Grant?	Yes			
53.i Reimbursement for education costs - Total received				Add dependent / self

54 Unclassified Education

54.a Tuition and enrolment fees excluding capital assessment/surcharges				
54.b Do you receive Education Grant?	Yes			
54.c Reimbursement for education costs - Total received				Add dependent / self

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4.3 QUINQUENNIAL (5-YEAR) EXPENDITURES

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Expenditure Category	INSIDE (the country of the duty station)		OUTSIDE (the country of the duty station)	
	In-area expenditure in local currency		Out-of-area expenditure	
	Amount	Currency	Amount	Currency

Please record the expenditures on Major electric and other household appliances; Major recreational durables; Jewellery and watches; Cars and other vehicles, **in the last five years**. If you sold a car you purchased within the past five years, kindly record both the purchase and the sale in the respective rows.

FURNISHINGS, HOUSEHOLD EQUIPMENT AND ROUTINE HOUSEHOLD MAINTENANCE

55	Major electric and other household appliances (Major kitchen appliances; Major laundry appliances; Heaters and air conditioners; Cleaning equipment; Other major household appliances)				

RECREATION, SPORT AND CULTURE

56	Major recreational durables (camper vans, caravans and trailers; gliders, hang gliders and hot-air balloons; boats, outboard motors and other water-sport equipment; horses, ponies, camels and dromedaries and accessories; Other major recreational durables)				

PERSONAL CARE, SOCIAL PROTECTION AND MISCELLANEOUS GOODS AND SERVICES

Other personal effects

57	Jewelry and watches				
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TRANSPORT

58 Purchase and sale of vehicles

Cars

58.a	Car 1 - Purchase				
58.b	Car 1 - Sale				
58.c	Car 2 - Purchase				
58.d	Car 2 - Sale				

Other vehicles

59.a	Other vehicles 1 - Purchase				
59.b	Other vehicles 1 - Sale				
59.c	Other vehicles 2 - Purchase				
59.d	Other vehicles 2 - Sale				

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SUBMIT